

MCQ Exam

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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Key Information

Date	Wednesday 11 March 2026
Time	During your normal lecture slot
Duration	1 hour
Location	Normal lecture venue
Format	Paper-based, multiple choice
Weight	20%

Exam Structure

The paper contains multiple “Investigations” — each is a short scenario describing a research study. For each Investigation, you answer 6 questions:

1. **Design:** Identify the design (between/within/matched/correlational)
2. **IV:** Identify the independent variable (or recognise no IV)
3. **DV:** Identify the dependent variable
4. **Hypothesis:** Identify the appropriate hypothesis type
5. **Test:** Select the appropriate statistical test
6. **Interpretation:** Interpret the results

There will be a series of other MCQs testing comprehension of other aspects of the course to date.

What You Need to Know

Statistical Tests

You must be able to select the appropriate test:

Design	Parametric	Non-parametric
Between-participants	Independent t-test	Mann-Whitney U
Within-participants	Paired t-test	Wilcoxon signed-rank
Correlational	Pearson's r	Spearman's rho

The Decision Framework

Design → Variables → Hypothesis → Test → Interpret

How to Prepare

Practice Makes Perfect

Complete the weekly self-assessment activities - they are designed to be exactly like the exam questions.

- Review the MCQ decision framework
- Focus on the logic and the concepts being used, not memorisation
- Practice identifying IVs and DVs from scenarios
- Understand when to use each statistical test

Exam Conditions

- **Closed-book:** No notes or materials allowed
- **No collaboration:** Individual assessment
- **Paper-based:** Bring a pen (not pencil)
- **No calculators:** Not required for this exam